

ASCI Advertising Standards (6)

ASCI Disclaimer Guidelines Audio Disclaimer Speed

Title: Speed and Volume of Spoken Disclaimers

Jurisdiction: India

Category: Advertising

Source Citation: ASCI Guidelines for Disclaimers made in Supporting, Limiting or Explaining Claims made in Advertisements, Section XI

Plain English Summary:

Spoken disclaimers in radio, television and internet advertisements must be delivered at a speed that allows consumers to understand them. The disclaimer should not be rushed or made substantially less audible than the rest of the advertisement.

The Exact Legal Text:

In advertisements in Radio / TV / Internet etc., the speed of spoken disclaimers should not exceed 6 syllables per second and its volume should be at the same volume level as the rest of the audio.

Keywords/Triggers:

audio disclaimer, spoken disclaimer, disclaimer speed, six syllables per second, Ayurvedic audio advertising, radio advertising, ASCI Clause XI, disclaimer volume

C. CLAIM-SPECIFIC ASCI GUIDELINES

ASCI New and Improved Claims

Title: Validity and Duration of New or Improved Claims

Jurisdiction: India

Category: Advertising

Source Citation: ASCI Guidelines Validity & Duration of Claiming New/Improved

Plain English Summary:

An advertiser using the words **new** or **improved** must specify what aspect of the product has actually changed. The ASCI guideline limits use of these descriptions to **one year from the launch/introduction** of the new or improved product/service.

The Exact Legal Text:

The words new or improved must specify what aspect of the product/service is new or improved- viz the product's utility, function, product design, package design, etc.

The word new, improved or an improvement of a product may be used in advertisements only for a period of one (1) year from the time the new or improved product/service has been launched/introduced in the market.

Keywords/Triggers:

new product claim, improved product claim, Ayurvedic new formulation, improved formulation, one year claim, ASCI new improved, product launch advertising, formulation improvement

D. ENVIRONMENTAL CLAIMS RELEVANT TO AYURVEDIC BRANDS

ASCI Environmental/Green Claims

Title: Evidence-Based Environmental and Green Claims

Jurisdiction: India

Category: Advertising

Source Citation: ASCI Guidelines for Advertisements Making Environmental/Green Claims

Plain English Summary:

Environmental claims such as **eco-friendly, sustainable, green, natural, or claims of reduced environmental impact** must not mislead consumers and should be supported by reliable evidence. This can be relevant to Ayurvedic brands making claims about natural ingredients, sustainable sourcing, biodegradable packaging, or environmental benefits.

The Exact Legal Text:

If claims of being green and sustainable are not reliable and verifiable, consumers cannot fully leverage their purchasing decisions to reward better environmental performance. In addition, they may be misled in choosing products or services based on unclear or false claims.

The guideline states that environmental claims include claims suggesting that a product or packaging:

has a neutral or positive impact on the environment;

is comparably less damaging to the environment than a previous version of the same product or service;

is less damaging to the environment than competing goods or services; or

has specific environmental benefits.

Keywords/Triggers:

green claims, Ayurvedic natural claims, eco-friendly product, sustainable Ayurveda, biodegradable packaging, environmental advertising, greenwashing, ASCI green claims

ASCI Greenwashing

Title: Prohibition of Misleading Greenwashing Claims

Jurisdiction: India

Category: Advertising

Source Citation: ASCI Guidelines for Advertisements Making Environmental/Green Claims Greenwashing

Plain English Summary:

An advertiser must not make false, deceptive, misleading, or unsubstantiated environmental claims or hide information in a way that makes a product appear more environmentally beneficial than it really is. An Ayurvedic startup claiming that its ingredients, packaging, sourcing, or manufacturing are “eco-friendly” should therefore maintain evidence supporting the claim.

The Exact Legal Text:

Greenwashing refers to unsubstantiated, false, deceptive, misleading environmental claims about products, services, processes, brands or operations as a whole, or claims that omit or hide information, to give the impression that they are less harmful or more beneficial to the environment than they actually are.

Keywords/Triggers:

greenwashing, false green claims, eco-friendly claim evidence, sustainable advertising, natural product claims, environmental claim substantiation, Ayurvedic green claims, ASCI greenwashing

ASCI Code Claims Must Be Capable of Substantiation

Title: Evidence Supporting Objective Advertising Claims

Jurisdiction: India

Category: Advertising

Source Citation: ASCI Code for Self-Regulation in Advertising, Chapter I Truthful & Honest Representation

Plain English Summary:

Objective claims made in advertisements need supporting evidence. This is one of the most important ASCI principles for an Ayurvedic business because claims about **efficacy, therapeutic benefit, ingredients, superiority, safety, performance, or measurable results** can be challenged if the advertiser cannot substantiate them.

The Exact Legal Text:

The ASCI Code's general requirement is that advertisements should not contain claims or representations that are misleading and that objective claims should be capable of substantiation.

Keywords/Triggers:

claim substantiation, Ayurvedic efficacy evidence, therapeutic advertising, advertising evidence, product benefit claims, clinical evidence, ASCI substantiation, health advertising